VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

SENGLAO (MAYOR)

Chai

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

Hang clan · Mai's husband; father of Chao and Gao cannot swim

Rally the Village

Once per season, free (it costs Chai no action), while Hope is 3 or more and not in Winter: one villager who has not acted yet this season takes 1 extra action.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Soul Lock · Silver Bar

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

TEACHER

Tou

HP ●●● ○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

Vang clan · The village teacher, Chai's oldest friend cannot swim

Talk Our Way Past

Once per season, when soldiers find the party (not the River Patrol), Tou speaks to them in Lao: draw a Fortune card, on 7 or more there is no fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Book · Translator

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

FARMER

Mai

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■ □□□□

Hang clan · Chai's wife; mother of Chao and Gao cannot swim

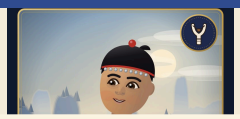
Hidden Harvest

Once per season, as an action, where anything grows this season: +4 Food, and no one sees her.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Hoe · Knife

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA



KID

Chao

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

Hang clan cannot swim

Runner

Once per season, as an action that eats no Food: Chao runs ahead and reveals 1 hidden place next to the party, the one farthest ahead. The party's next Travel needs no Danger draw: he has seen the way.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Slingshot · Tub Luj

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

KID

Gao

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

Hang clan · Daughter of Chai and Mai; Chao's little sister cannot swim

Hush

Once per season, when a noise or foraging draw would bring soldiers, Gao keeps everyone silent in the leaves: the soldiers pass by.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Doll · Rocks

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HUNTER

Sheng

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■ □□□□

Lee clan · Mai's younger sister

The Hunt

Once per season, free (it costs Sheng no action; not in Winter): draw a Fortune card. On 6 or more, +4 Food. On 5 or less the shot is heard: an Easy fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Bow · Hmong Gun

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

BLACKSMITH

Chong

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

Xiong clan · The blacksmith; Pao's cousin cannot swim

Bamboo Armor

Once per season, as an action: make a Bamboo Armor (body, Armor 1) for a villager with a free body slot. It falls apart after it has stopped 2 bullets.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Hammer · Sharpening Stone

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

SHAMAN

Meng

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

Yang clan · The shaman; Pa's nephew cannot swim

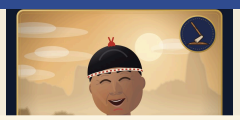
Spirits Are Here

Once per season, as an action: look at the top 3 cards of this place, put any Danger or Nothing cards on the bottom, then search here once with no noise.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Cloth Mask · Chu Neej

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA



FARMER

Pao

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

Thao clan

River Man

Once per season, as an action, where there is water (stream, bamboo, caves, jungle, fields, Lao village, riverbank, hamlet, ferry): +4 Food. At the river, one child, elder, sick or wounded villager crosses with him: 3 better on the current.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Scythe · Carrying Basket

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

RICE FARMER, MOTHER OF TWO
Mai

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▬ ▢▢▢▢

Hang clan · Chai's wife; mother of Chao and Gao · cannot swim

Every Grain

Always on. Mai's Forage finds 3 more Food wherever anything grows.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Hoe · Knife

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

TEACHER WHO READS THAI AND LAO
Tou

HP ●●● ○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ▬▬ ▢▢▢

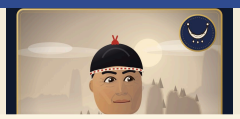
Vang clan · The village teacher, Chai's oldest friend · cannot swim

Reads the Signs

Always on. Tou's own searches look at 6 cards and keep 1 (the rest go to the bottom). The first search each season by anyone else looks at 2 and keeps 1.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Book · Translator

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA



SENGLAO IN EXILE
Chai

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ▬▬ ▢▢▢

Hang clan · Mai's husband; father of Chao and Gao · cannot swim

Keeps the Council

Always on. The council is offered 3 laws each Winter instead of 2, and every law it adopts gives Hope +1. Every Winter, if Hope is 1 or 0, Hope +1.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Soul Lock · Silver Bar

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

CROSSBOW HUNTER
Sheng

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▬ ▢▢▢▢

Lee clan · Mai's younger sister

Fresh Meat

Always on. Sheng's Forage finds 2 more Food wherever anything grows: snares, birds, fish traps. While Sheng holds a quiet weapon (bow, crossbow, spear, slingshot) the party fires first in every fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Bow · Hmong Gun

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

KID, LITTLE MOTHER
Gao

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▬▬ ▢▢▢

Hang clan · Daughter of Chai and Mai; Chao's little sister · cannot swim

Quiet Hands

Always on. Gao is never spotted while foraging, and her searches make no noise. Everyone else's noise is 2 lower.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Doll · Rocks

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

KID, MESSAGE RUNNER
Chao

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▬▬▬ ▢▢

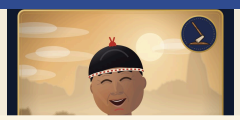
Hang clan · Son of Chai and Mai; Gao's big brother · cannot swim

Lookout

Always on. The party is never ambushed: when soldiers find you or catch you foraging, you shoot back from the first clash.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Slingshot · Tub Luj

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA



FISHERMAN-FARMER, STRONG SWIMMER
Pao

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ▬▬▬ ▢▢

Thao clan · Chong's cousin by marriage

Strong Swimmer

Always on. Pao's current draw is 2 better, and anyone swept away after Pao is across is pulled out 2 better. Forage where there is water finds 2 more Food.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Scythe · Carrying Basket

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

SHAMAN WHO READS THE BONES
Meng

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ▬▬ ▢▢▢

Yang clan · The shaman; Pa's nephew · cannot swim

Reads the Bones

Always on. Twice a year, when a Season card is drawn, Meng may put it on the bottom of the deck and draw another.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Cloth Mask · Chu Neej

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

RAFT BUILDER
Chong

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ▬▬▬ ▢▢

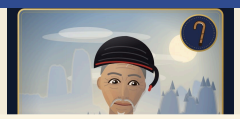
Xiong clan · The blacksmith; Pao's cousin · cannot swim

Builder

Always on. A camp Chong builds is finished in one action, and at the river the party's raft is free.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Hammer · Sharpening Stone

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA



ELDER
Blong

HP ●○○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

Hang clan · Chai's father; the grandfather cannot swim

The Old Road

Once per season, when the party Travels, Blong leads them by an old path: no Danger draw, and they gather 1 more Food on the way.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Cane Ring

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

SOLDIER
Cheng

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◆◇◇ DEF ■□□□□

Her clan · Bao's husband, home from the army cannot swim

Ready for Battle

Once per season, when a fight starts (not the River Patrol): the party has +2 ATK for that fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS
M-16 Hmong Knife

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

DOCTOR
Kong

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

Moua clan · The doctor; Lee's son-in-law cannot swim

Field Surgery

Once per season, after a fight: the most wounded survivor heals 1 wound on the spot.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Medicine Box Scalpel

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

MEDICINE WOMAN
Lee

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

Vue clan · The medicine woman; Kong's mother-in-law cannot swim

Fever Bark

Once per season, free (it costs Lee no action): cure one Sick villager and make a Healing Salve (HP +3, next fight).

AFFINITY ITEMS
Herbs Bandages

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

TAILOR
Bao

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

Lor clan · Cheng's wife, the tailor cannot swim

Winter Clothes

Once a year, free, in Fall or Winter: everyone draws 6 better at this Winter's Toll.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Needles Paj Ntaub

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

SINGER
Ka

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

Cha clan · The singer; Tou's niece cannot swim

Sing at Night

Once per season, free (it costs Ka no action): Ka sings kwv txhiaj by the fire. Hope +1, and the most wounded villager heals 1.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Qeej Tsaaj Nplaim

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

SHAMAN
Pa

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

Yang clan · Meng's aunt, a widow cannot swim

Call the Soul Back

Once a year, when a villager would die in a fight, Pa calls their soul back: they live with 1 HP.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Joss Paper Incense Sticks

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Soul Lock

+2 DEF for Chai; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Chai's item (Senglao (Mayor))

PACK

A soul lock of ancestral origin.

Families hid silver neck rings under the floor when they fled.

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Book

+2 DEF for Tou; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Tou's item (Teacher)

PACK

An old self-defense book of martial arts.

The village school was abandoned with its books on the shelf.

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

MEDIC TRAINED AT SAM THONG
Kong

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ▰▰ ▱▱▱

Moua clan · The doctor; Lee's son-in-law · cannot swim

Field Medic

Always on. Every Rest heals 1 more wound, and when Kong nurses the Sick, the fever always breaks.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Medicine Box · Scalpel

ENDINGS P. 28 VILLAGER · 12/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

SGU RADIO OPERATOR
Cheng

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▰▱▱▱

Her clan · Bao's husband, home from the army · cannot swim

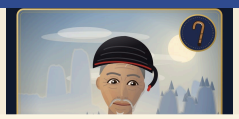
Return Fire

Always on. When the party is ambushed, it still shoots back in the first clash.

AFFINITY ITEMS
M-16 · Hmong Knife

ENDINGS P. 26 VILLAGER · 11/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA



ELDER WHO KNOWS THE OLD ROADS
Blong

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ▰▰▰ ▱▱

Hang clan · Chai's father; the grandfather · cannot swim

Knows the Hills

Always on. Every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Cane · Ring

ENDINGS P. 24 VILLAGER · 10/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

KWV TXHIAJ SINGER
Ka

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ▰▰▰ ▱▱

Cha clan · The singer; Tou's niece · cannot swim

Songs at Night

Always on. Hope never falls below 2, and at the start of every Winter her New Year songs give Hope +1.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Qeej · Tsaaj Nplaim

ENDINGS P. 34 VILLAGER · 15/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

TAILOR OF WARM CLOTHES
Bao

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ▰▰▰ ▱▱

Lor clan · Cheng's wife, the tailor · cannot swim

Warm Clothes

Always on. Everyone's Winter Toll is 3 better.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Needles · Paj Ntaub

ENDINGS P. 32 VILLAGER · 14/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

HERBALIST
Lee

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ▰▰ ▱▱▱

Vue clan · The medicine woman; Kong's mother-in-law · cannot swim

Wild Greens

Always on. Lee's Forage finds 1 more Food wherever anything grows, every Rest heals 1 more wound, and when Lee nurses someone Sick the fever always breaks.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Herbs · Bandages

ENDINGS P. 30 VILLAGER · 13/16

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

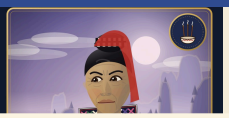
CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA



SHAMAN, SOUL CALLER
Pa

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ▰▰ ▱▱▱

Calls the Soul Home

Always on. A death costs no Hope: Pa leads the rites. A fever Pa nurses always breaks. Once a game, the first villager the Toll would take is spared (hu plig). Winter at Hope 0 or 1: Hope +1. Once a year she reads the bones: put a drawn Season card under the deck, draw another.

AFFINITY ITEMS
Joss Paper · Incense Sticks

ENDINGS P. 36 VILLAGER · 16/16

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Doll

+2 HP for Gao; +1 HP for anyone else.

Gao's item (Kid)

PACK

A Hmong doll.

A child's doll left on a sleeping platform.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 3/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Hammer

+2 ATK for Chong; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chong's item (Blacksmith)

ONE HAND

An iron hammer.

The village blacksmith's forge still has its tools.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 4/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Ring

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Blong; +1 HP for anyone else.

Blong's item (Elder)

PACK

A very old ring with intricate carvings.

An heirloom ring in a wooden box under the altar.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 5/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Needles

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Bao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Bao's item (Tailor)

PACK

Needles used for sewing.

Every house has needles and thread for paj ntaub.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 6/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Paj Ntaub

+1 DEF, +1 HP for Bao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Bao's item (Tailor)

BODY

Clothing that is used for show (flower cloth needlework).

Flower cloth folded in a chest for the New Year.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 7/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM
Su-Kah

+1 DEF for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.

PACK

A household talisman used to protect a house.

The household spirit altar on the back wall of the house.

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 8/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
French Silver Coins

Pays one boat seat when you have found a Boatman. Also +1 HP.

PACK

Old French Indochina silver piastres, the savings of a family.

Families sewed coins into clothes or buried them under the house.

MONEY

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 9/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Iron Rice Pot

The holder finds 1 extra Food each time they Forage. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A heavy iron pot for steaming rice and boiling greens.

Every hearth had one, and few families could carry it.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 10/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Village Flintlock

A hunting gun: +2 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A long flintlock musket made by a Hmong blacksmith.

Hmong smiths made their own guns; one hung over many doorways.

LOUD

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 11/19

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

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SEARCH · HOME

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SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
Wood Axe

A tool and a weapon: +1 ATK, +1 DEF.

ONE HAND

A narrow-bladed axe for felling and splitting.

Every house kept one by the woodpile.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 12/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

FOOD
Rice left in a granary

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Village Ruins.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 13/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

FOOD
Rice left in a granary

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Village Ruins.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 14/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I
Soldiers searching the ruins

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Your own village or a neighbour's, burned or abandoned when the soldiers came. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 15/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

SHELTER
A standing house wall

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 16/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 17/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

NOTHING
Already picked over

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 18/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
A Letter from Nong Khai

Key encounter, one step harder than easy: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A cousin who crossed last year wrote where the camp is and who helped him. **It is in the headman's burned house, and soldiers are still searching the ruins.**

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 19/19

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

ITEM
Hoe

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Mai; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Mai's item (Farmer)

BOTH HANDS

A garden hoe.

Hoes were left in the field huts at the end of the season.

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 1/17

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

ITEM
Knife

+1 DEF, +1 HP for Mai; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Mai's item (Farmer)
ONE HAND
A garden knife.

The field knife hangs in every field hut for clearing brush.

ITEM
Slingshot

+2 ATK for Chao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chao's item (Kid)
ONE HAND
A slingshot made of wood and rubber bands.

Boys guarded the ripening corn from birds with slingshots.

QUIET

ITEM
Tub Luj

+2 DEF for Chao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Chao's item (Kid)
PACK
A toy circular object that can be thrown (Hmong spinning top).

Children spun tops on the packed earth by the field huts while their parents worked.

ITEM
Scythe

+2 ATK for Pao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Pao's item (Farmer)
BOTH HANDS
A garden scythe.

Harvest tools stored in the granary by the field.

ITEM
Carrying Basket (Kwb)

+2 DEF for Pao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Pao's item (Farmer)
PACK
A kwb used to carry items and vegetables from the farm.

Carrying baskets are left at the field hut, ready for harvest.

LEGENDARY ITEM
Water Buffalo

+1 DEF for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

SHARED BY THE PARTY
A water buffalo used to till rice fields.

A buffalo left in a burned field. It can be slaughtered for meat (4 Food, but -1 Hope).

ANIMAL

ITEM
Gourd Water Bottle

Clean boiled water: the holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK
A dried gourd that carries water.

Gourds grew on the field fences and carried water to the fields.

SUPPLIES
Sack of Seed Rice

Gain 3 Food when found. (Then discard it.)

SHARED BY THE PARTY
A sack of rice kept back for next year's planting.

Seed rice was stored in the field granary.

⊘ USED SIDE

ITEM
Machete

A tool and a weapon: +2 ATK.

ONE HAND
A heavy field blade for clearing brush.

Left in a field hut when the family ran.

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

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CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

FOOD

Ripe corn and pumpkins

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Swidden Fields.

FOOD

Ripe corn and pumpkins

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Swidden Fields.

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A patrol burning the fields

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Hillside fields of upland rice and corn, cleared by slash-and-burn. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

REMEDY

Ginger and herbs from the garden

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the next fight.

Rest, medicine or care.

NOTHING

Burned

No effect. Discard this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

ESCAPE

Smoke From the Fields

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, no fight.

A way past the soldiers in the Swidden Fields.

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

Talk of the Road South

Key encounter, one step harder than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight one step up). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Farmers in the field huts know which paths the soldiers watch. **The farmers will talk, but their own children are hungry.**

ITEM

Bow

+2 ATK for Sheng; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Sheng's item (Hunter)

BOTH HANDS

A bow used to hunt pheasants and small animals.

Hunters kept bows in their ridge-top shelters.

QUIET

ITEM

Hmong Gun

+3 ATK for Sheng; +2 ATK for anyone else.

Sheng's item (Hunter)

BOTH HANDS

A gun with a very long barrel, used to hunt small game.

Long flintlock hunting guns were hidden in hunting shelters.

LOUD

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

Cane

+2 DEF for Blong; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Blong's item (Elder)

ONE HAND

A solid wooden cane for the elderly.

A straight walking stick cut from the ridge forest.

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

Horse

+1 HP for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A mountain pony.

A pony carries three loads and cannot enter the caves or cross the river. It can be slaughtered for meat.

ANIMAL

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

Crossbow (hneev)

Hunting: the holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage. Also +2 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A Hmong hunting crossbow with bamboo bolts.

Hunters kept crossbows in their ridge-top shelters.

QUIET

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

Pine-Resin Torch

When the holder Searches, look at 2 cards and keep 1 (put the other on the bottom).

ONE HAND

A bundle of pine splinters soaked in resin.

Pine pitch burns slowly; hunters lit their way with it.

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

Hunting Spear

Keeps danger at arm's length: +1 ATK, +1 DEF.

BOTH HANDS

An iron spearhead bound to a bamboo shaft.

Hunters kept spears for wild pig in their ridge shelters.

QUIET

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

FOOD

Wild mushrooms and a bird

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Pine Ridge.

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

FOOD

Wild mushrooms and a bird

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Pine Ridge.

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I

A tiger on the ridge

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

High, cool pine forest along the ridgeline above the villages. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

SHELTER

A hunter's shelter

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the next fight.

A safe place to make a stand.

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

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SEARCH · THE HILLS

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CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

NOTHING

Nothing but pine needles

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 12/14

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

A Hidden Path

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Pine Ridge.

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 13/14

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

Signal Fires

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Resistance fighters light fires on the ridges to mark the safe way down. **The fires are lit only after dark, and the patrols watch the ridges too.**

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 14/14

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Army Blanket

The holder draws 1 better at the Winter Toll. Also +1 DEF.

PACK

A heavy wool blanket from the war years.

Blankets came in supply drops to the hill airstrips.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Transistor Radio

Look at the next Season card at any time.

PACK

A battery radio.

Left in the radio hut at the strip. Radios carried news of patrols and of the camps in Thailand. Once a season, look at the top Season card and put it back.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Cargo Parachute

A dry tent: the holder draws 1 better at the Winter Toll. Also +1 DEF.

PACK

A nylon cargo parachute, white or striped.

Parachutes from rice drops lay snagged in the trees around the strips; families made tents and clothes from them.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Steel Helmet

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

HEAD

An American steel helmet from the war years.

Dropped with other supplies at the hill airstrips.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Flak Vest

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

BODY

A padded vest left by an aircrew.

Abandoned in a shed when the airstrip was evacuated.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

FOOD

A torn sack of air-dropped rice

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Long Tieng Airstrip.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

FOOD

A torn sack of air-dropped rice

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Long Tieng Airstrip.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

Soldiers watching the strip

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The long dirt runway of Long Tieng, the Hmong army's old headquarters, between the karst hills. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

SHELTER

A burned-out supply hut

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

CLUE

A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

NOTHING

Bare red earth

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

A Pilot's River Chart

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old air chart with the Mekong fords marked in pencil. **It is in the pocket of a dead soldier by the burned huts. His patrol is close.**

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

Tsaaj Nplaim

+2 HP for Ka; +1 HP for anyone else.

Ka's item (Singer)

PACK

An instrument used to court people.

A leaf or bamboo-reed courting instrument made in the grove.

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 1/13

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

Bamboo Float Tubes

The holder draws 2 better crossing the river.

PACK

Sealed lengths of giant bamboo tied together.

Non-swimmers tied bamboo tubes under their arms to cross the Mekong.

FLOAT

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 2/13

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

Bundle of Raft Poles

Lets the party build a raft without giving up 2 items.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Long dry bamboo poles, cut and bundled.

Giant bamboo floats well and was lashed into rafts.

RAFT

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 3/13

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Long Tieng Airstrip

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

ITEM
Snare Traps

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

Wire and cord snares for birds and small animals.

Hunters set snares on the rat and bird trails through the bamboo.

FOOD
Bamboo shoots

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Bamboo Forest.

FOOD
Bamboo shoots

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Bamboo Forest.

DANGER · EASY I
A militia patrol on the path

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Dense groves of giant bamboo in the valleys below the ridges. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

REMEDY
Clean bamboo water

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

NOTHING
Only old bamboo

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

AMBUSH · EASY I
Soldiers waiting in the grove

Easy fight now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Dense groves of giant bamboo in the valleys below the ridges.

ESCAPE
A Tunnel Through the Bamboo

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Bamboo Forest.

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED
Blazes on the Bamboo

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Families who went before cut marks in the bamboo to show the path. **The soldiers found the marks too, and mined the path.**

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Raft-Maker's Word

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A man cutting bamboo says which stream carries rafts down to the Mekong. **He has a family to feed and will not say for nothing.**

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 13/1

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Herbs

+2 HP for Lee; +1 HP for anyone else.

Lee's item (Medicine Woman)

PACK

Various herbs that smell sweet.

Medicine plants grow wild in the deep forest.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

Dog

+1 HP for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A village dog used to guard a house.

A village dog that ran into the forest finds you.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Rattan Rope

The holder draws 1 better crossing the river (tied to the raft or the others). Also +1 DEF.

PACK

Rope twisted from split rattan cane.

Rattan vines grow in the deep forest.

FLOAT

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Dropped Rifle

A strong weapon: +3 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A rifle left beside the trail with a few rounds.

Soldiers of the Secret Army dropped heavy gear as they fled through the forest.

LOUD

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

Rattan Shield

Armor 1 and +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

ONE HAND

A round shield of woven rattan, hardened over smoke.

Made in the forest from split rattan cane.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

FOOD

Wild yams and fruit

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

FOOD

Wild yams and fruit

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A sweep through the jungle

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A sweep through the jungle

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

SHELTER

A hidden hollow

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

REMEDY

Healing leaves

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

CLUE

A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

NOTHING

Lost in the undergrowth

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II

An ambush in the undergrowth

Medium fight now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ESCAPE

Monsoon Rain

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

A Resistance Courier

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A runner tells you where and when to meet the people who can help. **He is pinned down in a gully by a patrol. Free him and he will talk.**

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Soldier Who Deserted

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

He fought for the other side and knows where the patrols sleep. **He wants silver, or a gun, before he trusts you.**

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Khao Khouay Jungle

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Silver Bar

+2 HP for Chai; +1 HP for anyone else.

Chai's item (Senglao (Mayor))

PACK

A silver bar used in bartering and trade.

Families hid their silver in caves before they fled.

MONEY

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 1/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Cloth Mask

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Meng; +1 HP for anyone else.

Meng's item (Shaman)

HEAD

A cloth mask used to cover your face.

The shaman's things were carried to the caves for safekeeping.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 2/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Chu Neej

+2 DEF for Meng; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Meng's item (Shaman)

PACK

A jingle set made of iron and brass.

Shaman's rattles were hidden with other sacred things in caves.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 3/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Hmong Knife

+2 ATK for Cheng; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Cheng's item (Soldier)

ONE HAND

A Hmong knife used in butchering animals and general use.

Resistance fighters cached knives and tools in caves.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 4/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Medicine Box

+2 HP for Kong; +1 HP for anyone else.

Kong's item (Doctor)

PACK

A medicine box.

An aid post of the resistance kept its medicine box in a cave.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 5/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Qeej

+1 DEF, +1 HP for Ka; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Ka's item (Singer)

PACK

An instrument used to help call spirits.

A qeej carried up to the caves so the funeral songs would not be lost.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 6/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Incense Sticks

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Pa; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Pa's item (Shaman)

PACK

Incense sticks used to help call spirits.

Incense left at a cave shrine.

USED SIDE

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 7/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Old Carbine

A strong weapon: +3 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

An American carbine from the Secret Army years.

Soldiers of the resistance cached weapons in caves.

LOUD

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 8/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
Army Poncho

Dry in the monsoon: the holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 DEF.

BODY

A rubberised rain poncho.

Left with other supplies in a resistance cave.

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 9/1

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SUPPLIES
Hidden Rice Cache

Gain 4 Food when found. (Then discard it.)

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Jars of rice hidden at the back of a cave.

Families stored rice in caves to hide it from soldiers.

⊘ USED SIDE

FOOD
Rice hidden in a jar

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Limestone Caves.

FOOD
Rice hidden in a jar

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Limestone Caves.

DANGER · MEDIUM II
Soldiers search the caves

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Caves in the karst towers, dry inside even in the monsoon. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SHELTER
A dry cave

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

REMEDY
An aid-post first-aid kit

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

NOTHING
An empty cave

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

ESCAPE
A Back Way Out

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Limestone Caves.

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
Names on the Cave Wall

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Families scratched their names and the way they went into the rock. **Soldiers are camped in the mouth of the cave.**

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Shaman's Blessing

Key encounter, one step harder than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A txiv neeb calls the spirits to guide the family across the water. **The ceremony needs an offering: incense, paper money, a rooster, or rice.**

THE TRAIL LIMESTONE CAVES · 19/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Translator

+2 HP for Tou; +1 HP for anyone else.

Tou's item (Teacher)

PACK

A guide used to help translate Hmong to Lao.

Lowland traders kept Hmong-Lao word lists for doing business with hill people.

DISGUISE

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 1/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Bandages

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Lee; +1 HP for anyone else.

Lee's item (Medicine Woman)

PACK

Crudely made bandages.

Cloth bought or begged from lowland villagers.

USED SIDE

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 2/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Joss Paper

+2 HP for Pa; +1 HP for anyone else.

Pa's item (Shaman)

PACK

Joss paper used as offerings for the dead.

Spirit paper sold by lowland traders.

USED SIDE

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 3/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

Rooster

+1 ATK for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A village rooster meant to wake people up.

A rooster traded or caught in a lowland village.

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 4/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Lao Clothes

Disguise: every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better.

BODY

A Lao sarong and plain shirt.

Dressing as lowland Lao helped families pass through villages and checkpoints.

DISGUISE

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 5/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Bag of Salt

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage (salted food lasts). Also +1 HP.

PACK

Coarse salt from the lowland salt wells.

Highlanders bought salt from Lao traders; it keeps fish and meat.

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 6/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Mosquito Net

The holder draws 1 better at the Toll.

PACK

A cotton mosquito net.

Lowland traders sold nets; malaria killed many people in hiding.

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 7/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

Quinine Tablets

The holder draws 2 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A small bottle of malaria tablets.

Bought at a lowland market for silver.

USED SIDE

THE TRAIL LAO FARM VILLAGE · 8/

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

ITEM

Padded Cotton Jacket

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. Warm: 1 better at the Toll.

BODY

A quilted jacket stuffed with kapok.

Lowland tailors sold padded jackets for the cold season.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 9

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

FOOD

Sticky rice from a kind family

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Lao Farm Village.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 10

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

FOOD

Sticky rice from a kind family

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Lao Farm Village.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 11

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

Someone reports you

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 12

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I

Someone reports you

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 13

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

REMEDY

A village healer

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the next fight.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 14

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

CLUE

A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 15

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

CLUE

A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 16

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

NOTHING

Doors stay shut

No effect. Discard this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 17

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II

A trap at the well

Medium fight now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 18

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

A Friendly Warning

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Lao Farm Village.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 19

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Lao Friend's Promise

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A Lao farmer will hide you near the river on the night you cross. **He is risking his family. He asks for silver, or rice.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 20

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

Market Gossip

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

At market they say which nights the river patrols change. **You must wait by the market until dark to hear it, where anyone could see you.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 21

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

The Headman's Pass

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A stamped paper that lets a family walk the lowland roads. **The stamp is kept at the militia post at the edge of the village.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 22

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

A Monk at the Temple

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A Lao monk tells travellers which villages along the river are kind to strangers. **He will speak only after evening prayers, and the militia walks past the temple at dusk.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 23

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

M-16

+3 ATK for Cheng; +2 ATK for anyone else.

Cheng's item (Soldier)

BOTH HANDS

An American-issued M-16.

Rifles from the Secret Army were taken at checkpoints and left in army stores.

LOUD

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 1/18

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

Scalpel

+2 HP for Kong; +1 HP for anyone else.

Kong's item (Doctor)

PACK

A sharp scalpel.

An army medic's kit dropped by the road.

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 2/18

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

Forged Travel Pass

Every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better.

PACK

A stamped paper allowing travel to the river towns.

Passes were bought, forged or taken at checkpoints.

DISGUISE

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 3/18

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

ITEM
Captured Rifle

A strong weapon: +3 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A rifle taken from an army store.

Army posts along the roads kept weapons and ammunition.

LOUD

SUPPLIES
Army Rations

Gain 3 Food when found. (Then discard it.)

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Tins of fish and bags of rice.

Supply trucks stopped at the checkpoint.

USED SIDE

ITEM
Army Body Armor

Armor 2 and +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

BODY

A heavy vest taken from an army store.

The checkpoint stores held gear for the soldiers on the road.

FOOD
A dropped sack of rice

+3 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Hin Heup Bridge.

FOOD
A dropped sack of rice

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Hin Heup Bridge.

DANGER · HARD III
The checkpoint guards

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

DANGER · HARD III
The checkpoint guards

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

CLUE
A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

NOTHING
Too many soldiers

No effect. Discard this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

AMBUSH · HARD III

Shots from the ditch

Hard fight now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end.

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 13/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

ESCAPE

A Ditch by the Road

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Hin Heup Bridge.

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 14/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

A Patrol Timetable

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Overheard at the checkpoint: when the trucks come and go. **To hear it you must get close to the checkpoint itself.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 15/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Guard Who Looks Away

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

One guard will let a family pass for a little silver. **Only for silver. If you will not pay, he calls the others.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 16/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED

A Burned-Out Truck

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

In the cab of a burned army truck, papers with the river posts marked. **The road shoulder around the truck is mined.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 17/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Ride on a Logging Truck

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A driver will hide a family under the logs as far as the river road. **He wants silver first. Without it he drives on, and he has seen your faces.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 18/1

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

ITEM

Rocks

+2 HP for Gao; +1 HP for anyone else.

Gao's item (Kid)

ONE HAND

A small shiny rock.

Smooth bright stones from the streambed.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 1/15

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

ITEM

Sharpening Stone

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Chong; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chong's item (Blacksmith)

PACK

A sharpening stone used to retouch items.

The best whetstones are flat stones from a fast stream.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 2/15

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

Fishing Pole

+1 ATK for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

BOTH HANDS

A fishing pole used to catch fish.

A bamboo rod left by a fisherman.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 3/15

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

ITEM
Cast Net

The holder finds 2 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

A round weighted fishing net.

Lowland fishermen leave nets drying on the rocks.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

ITEM
Clay Water Jar

The holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A jar for carrying and boiling water.

Potters worked the clay banks of the streams.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

FOOD
Fish and river crabs

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Nam Xan Valley.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

FOOD
Fish and river crabs

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Nam Xan Valley.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I
A patrol at the ford

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A rocky stream running down into the Nam Xan, the river that meets the Mekong at Paksane. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

SHELTER
An overhanging rock

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

NOTHING
Empty water

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
The Stream's Mouth

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Follow the water down and it meets the Mekong at a quiet bend. **The bend can only be reached at night, when the fishermen have gone home.**

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

Footprints in the Mud

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Other families came this way, and recently. **The trail ends at a soldier dead in the reeds. In his pack is a list of the fords, and his unit is looking for him.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 13/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

A Smugglers' Path

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Salt and opium traders use a path through the reeds that the army does not know. **The traders guard their path, and they shoot first.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 14/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Buffalo Boy's Shortcut

Key encounter, **one step harder** than easy: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A boy herding buffalo knows a dry way through the paddies to the river. **He wants rice for his family before he will show you.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 15/1

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

ITEM

Truck Inner Tube

The holder draws 3 better crossing the river.

PACK

A patched rubber inner tube.

Inner tubes were the best floats a family could find.

FLOAT

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 1/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

ITEM

Driftwood Logs

Lets the party build a raft without giving up 2 items.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Logs washed up on the bank.

The Mekong leaves timber on every sandbar.

RAFT

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 2/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

FOOD

Mussels and river weed

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 3/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

FOOD

Mussels and river weed

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 4/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A river patrol

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Reeds and mud flats on the Lao bank between Vientiane and Paksane, with Thailand across the water. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 5/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

REMEDY

Rest by the water

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 6/15

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 7/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 8/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 9/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

NOTHING
Mud and reeds

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 10/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II
Rifles in the reeds

Medium fight now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Reeds and mud flats on the Lao bank between Vientiane and Paksane, with Thailand across the water.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 11/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

ESCAPE
Fog on the River

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 12/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
Lights on the Thai Bank

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

You can see the lamps of a Thai village. Now you know where to aim. **The lamps can only be seen after dark, from the open bank.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 13/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
A Hidden Landing

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A gap in the reeds where rafts are put in at night. **A river patrol has found it and waits there.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 14/15

SEARCH · MEKO… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE
A Boatman's Son

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A boy who helps his father ferry families knows which night they go. **His father will want silver or baht for a place on the list.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 15/15

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

ITEM
Thai Baht Notes

Pays one boat seat when you have found a Boatman.

PACK

Paper money from across the river.

Fishermen traded across the river and took baht for passage.

MONEY

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

ITEM
Bamboo Fish Trap

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

A woven cone trap for fish.

Every fishing family has a few.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

FOOD
Dried fish

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Fishing Hamlet.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

FOOD
Dried fish

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Fishing Hamlet.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II
A fisherman turns you in

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A few stilt houses of Lao fishermen with boats pulled up on the bank. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

SHELTER
A friendly family hides you

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

NOTHING
No one answers

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 10/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

ESCAPE
Under the Stilt Houses

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Fishing Hamlet.

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 11/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE
The Fisherman's Signal

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Three flashes of a torch from the far bank mean it is safe. **The fisherman wants paying for the signal. If you will not pay, he may go to the soldiers.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 12/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
A Night With No Moon

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old woman tells you when the next dark night will be. **She tells you only after you have waited with her through the night.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 13/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN
A Patrol Book in the Nets

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A patrolman drowned in the nets. His book has the boat times. **His comrades are dragging the river for him.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 14/14

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

ITEM
Dugout Canoe

Two people may cross by boat without paying a boatman.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A narrow dugout canoe hidden in the reeds.

The ferrymen kept small boats near the old landing.

BOAT

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 1/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

FOOD
Rice from an empty guardhouse

+3 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Tha Deua Ferry.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 2/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

FOOD
Rice from an empty guardhouse

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Tha Deua Ferry.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 3/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III
The guard post

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The old ferry landing below Vientiane, where the boats to Nong Khai crossed, now a guarded army post. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 4/12

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III
The guard post

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The old ferry landing below Vientiane, where the boats to Nong Khai crossed, now a guarded army post. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE
A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

NOTHING
Searchlights

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
The Guard Change

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

For a few minutes after midnight, no one watches the landing. **You must get past the outer guards to see it.**

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
The Ferryman's Hut

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old ferryman who lost his boat knows every sandbar between here and Thailand. **He comes back to his hut only at night, past the guard post.**

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED
A Boat Left Untied

Key encounter, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A small boat at the end of the old pier, if you can reach it. **The path to the pier is mined and lit.**

SEARCH · PLAIN ... CHAO FA

ITEM
Bomb Casing Pot

+1 Food whenever the party forages.

PACK

Half a cluster-bomb casing, blackened by cooking fires.

Families on the plain cooked in the halves of the bomb casings that lay everywhere.

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ITEM

Drop Tarpaulin

The Winter Toll is 1 better for everyone.

PACK

A rotted supply-drop tarpaulin, still waterproof.

Rice drops came wrapped in tarpaulin. A sheet of it keeps the rain off a shelter.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 2/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ITEM

Entrenching Tool

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for anyone.

ONE HAND

A folding army shovel.

Dropped by a soldier on the plain. It digs a firing position or a grave.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 3/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

FOOD

Rice from an abandoned paddy

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 4/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

FOOD

Frogs from the craters

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 5/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A patrol on the open plain

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 6/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I

Militia at the jars

Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 7/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

OLD BOMBS

Bomblets in the grass

Everyone draws a **Fortune card**: on 1 or 2, an old bomb, **2 wounds**. The Dog: only on a 1. Then discard this card.

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 8/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

OLD BOMBS

A crater field

Everyone draws a **Fortune card**: on 1 or 2, an old bomb, **2 wounds**. The Dog: only on a 1. Then discard this card.

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 9/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

SHELTER

A crater to lie in

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 10/13

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

NOTHING
Only the jars

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 11/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ESCAPE
Across the Plain by Night

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 12/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE
The Road Watcher's Word

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old man who watches the road knows which trucks carry soldiers. **He wants rice for his word.**

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 13/13

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
Pahawh Primer

+1 DEF for anyone.

PACK

A hand-copied primer in the Pahawh script.

The Chao Fa taught the script of Shong Lue Yang in their camps. The book is their mark and their memory.

CHAO FA

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 1/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
Field Dressing

Counts as medicine for nursing. Turn it face down when used.

PACK

A sealed army field dressing.

Carried by every fighter on the mountain. Counts as medicine for nursing.

USED SIDE

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 2/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
Soldier's Map

Searching: look at one card more and choose.

PACK

A map case with a marked sheet of the Phou Bia massif.

The mountain fighters marked the paths and the hiding places. Searches here look one card deeper.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 3/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

FOOD
A hidden camp's rice

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Bia Slopes.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 4/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

FOOD
Mountain roots

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Bia Slopes.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 5/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III
Soldiers climbing the mountain

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 6/14

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

A patrol on the ridge path

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

THE CHAO FA

The Chao Fa Take You In

A band of resistance fighters shares their fire and their rifles for a while. Your next 3 fights: the party has +3 ATK. Keep it face up and turn it after the third fight.

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families.

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

CLUE

A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

REMEDY

A night in a Chao Fa camp

Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

NOTHING

Cold, and nothing to eat

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ESCAPE

Cloud on the Mountain

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Phou Bia Slopes.

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

The Fighters' Trail

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

The Chao Fa know the way down to the river, and who is watching it. **Their camp is watched from below.**

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

A Fighter's Last Word

Key encounter, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A dying fighter names the crossing his family used. **He fell on the path, and the soldiers who shot him are close.**

SEARCH · VIENTI… CHAO FA

ITEM

Ball of Opium

Money: pays a Boatman, a Price, a Trade or a shakedown. Or spend it: a **Sick** villager is not **Sick** for one Winter Toll.

PACK

A fist of raw opium wrapped in leaves.

The cash crop of the mountains and the medicine chest of the sick. Money: it pays a Boatman, a Price or a Trade. Or spend it so a Sick villager is not Sick for one Winter Toll (it eases, it does not cure).

MONEY

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Phou Bia Slopes

CHAO FA

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ITEM

Lao Identity Card

Danger 1 better when you Travel. A disguise piece: with two in the party, no one looks twice.

PACK

A lowland Lao identity card with a stranger's photograph.

On the plain everyone is asked for papers. A card, even a stranger's, gets the party past a glance.

DISGUISE

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ITEM

Kerosene Lamp

Searching: look at one card more and choose.

PACK

A tin lamp with a little kerosene left.

Light to search by, if you dare to show one.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

FOOD

The market at dawn

+3 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Vientiane Plain.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

FOOD

Paddy rice and fish sauce

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Vientiane Plain.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III

A checkpoint on the road

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III

Soldiers searching a bus

Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

Militia in the paddies

Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

CLUE

A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

NOTHING

Too many eyes

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

A Monk's Blessing

Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Vientiane Plain.

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

A Trader's Route

Key encounter, one step harder than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A market trader runs goods to the river and knows the quiet landings. **He sells to anyone, including the police.**

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

Papers for the Ferry

Key encounter, one step harder than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A clerk sells the stamp that gets a family onto the ferry. **The stamp costs more than you have.**

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

The Night Bus Driver

Key encounter, one step harder than hard: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A driver who takes people to the river town after dark. **He only drives when the road is empty.**

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

A patrol finds you

Easy fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

A patrol finds you

Easy fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

A patrol finds you

Easy fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

A patrol finds you

Easy fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

A patrol finds you

Easy fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

A patrol finds you

Medium fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 6/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

A patrol finds you

Medium fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 7/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

A patrol finds you

Medium fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 8/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

A patrol finds you

Medium fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 9/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

A patrol finds you

Medium fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 10/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

A patrol finds you

Hard fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 11/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

A patrol finds you

Hard fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 12/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

A patrol finds you

Hard fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 13/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

A patrol finds you

Hard fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 14/85

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

A patrol finds you

Hard fight now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 15/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +3

+3 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 16/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +3

+3 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 17/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 18/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 19/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 20/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 21/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 22/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 23/85

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD
Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 24/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD
Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 25/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
DEF +3

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +3 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 26/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
DEF +2

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 27/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
DEF +2

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 28/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
DEF +1

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 29/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
DEF +1

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 30/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
HP +3

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +3 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 31/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
HP +2

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 32/85

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
HP +2

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 33/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
HP +1

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 34/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
HP +1

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 35/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
The Army Advances

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 36/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
The Army Advances

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 37/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
The Army Advances

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 38/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
The Army Advances

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 39/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
The Army Advances

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 40/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
A Sweep Through the Hills

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 41/85

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

A Sweep Through the Hills

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 42/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

A Sweep Through the Hills

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 43/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

A Quiet Spell

This season Travel is safe (no Danger draw) and no one is spotted while foraging.

The soldiers are busy elsewhere.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 44/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1976

HISTORY

Yellow Rain

Each person draws a **Fortune card**: on 4 or less they fall **Sick** (if already **Sick**, they take **a wound**).

Aircraft pass low over the ridge. Refugees later told of a yellow substance falling, and of sickness and deaths after. What it was is still disputed.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 45/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SPRING 1977

HISTORY

The Offensive on Phou Bia

The party loses **half its Food** (rounded up), and a **Medium patrol** finds you.

Lao and Vietnamese troops sweep the mountains where the resistance holds out. Villages and rice fields are burned.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 46/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

A Voice on the Radio

Lose 1 Hope. Then, if Hope is 2 or less, the most hurt villager goes down to **surrender** and leaves the party.

A radio voice speaking Hmong promises rice, land and forgiveness to anyone who comes down from the mountains. Some did. Many officers who went down were sent to camps and never came back.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 47/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

A Voice on the Radio

Lose 1 Hope. Then, if Hope is 2 or less, the most hurt villager goes down to **surrender** and leaves the party.

A radio voice speaking Hmong promises rice, land and forgiveness to anyone who comes down from the mountains. Some did. Many officers who went down were sent to camps and never came back.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 48/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

HISTORY

Betrayed

A **Medium patrol** finds you. If you have a Guide, the Guide was the traitor: lose the Guide card, and the patrol is Hard.

Someone has told the soldiers where you sleep. Hmong fought on both sides of this war, and some guided the soldiers who hunted their own people.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 49/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

HISTORY

Betrayed

A **Medium patrol** finds you. If you have a Guide, the Guide was the traitor: lose the Guide card, and the patrol is Hard.

Someone has told the soldiers where you sleep. Hmong fought on both sides of this war, and some guided the soldiers who hunted their own people.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 50/85

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · HISTO… CHAO FA

HISTORY

Bombs in the Grass

Each person draws a **Fortune card**: on 2 or less they step on one and take **2 wounds**.

The path crosses ground bombed in the war. Small round bomblets lie in the grass and mud, and nearly one in three never went off.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 51/85

SEASON · HISTO… CHAO FA

HISTORY

Bombs in the Grass

Each person draws a **Fortune card**: on 2 or less they step on one and take **2 wounds**.

The path crosses ground bombed in the war. Small round bomblets lie in the grass and mud, and nearly one in three never went off.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 52/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

A Wounded Soldier

A wounded man from the resistance crawls into your camp and asks to come with you.

Take him in. Share your food. He knows where a cache is hidden, but the soldiers hunting him may follow.

−3 Food, +1 Hope, 1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

Leave him. You cannot feed another mouth, and soldiers may be tracking him.

−1 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 53/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

A Lao Family's Granary

A lowland family has a full rice granary. Your children are hungry.

Take rice at night. Fill your baskets and hope no one wakes.

+3 Food, −1 Hope, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

Ask to trade. Offer something you carry. They give what they can spare.

+2 Food, give up an item

THE TRAIL SEASON · 54/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

Another Family

A mother and two children beg to travel with you. They have nothing.

Welcome them. They share your fire and your rice until they find their own people.

−3 Food, +2 Hope

Turn them away. Every mouth slows the party.

−2 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 55/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

Fever in the Night

A child is burning with fever. Your medicine is almost gone.

Use the medicine. Give up a healing item, if you have one, to bring the fever down.

+1 Hope, give up an item, a sick or wounded person recovers

Call the spirits and wait. The shaman sits with the child through the night. The fever breaks at dawn, but the child is weak.

+1 Hope, someone takes 1 wound

THE TRAIL SEASON · 56/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

An Abandoned Harvest

A field of ripe rice, its owners gone. Soldiers patrol the valley by day.

Harvest by day. Take as much as you can carry.

+4 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

Glean at night. Take only what you can find in the dark.

+2 Food

THE TRAIL SEASON · 57/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

Hmong New Year

It is the New Year (Noj Peb Caug). In the village there would be feasting, ball games and new clothes.

Celebrate quietly. Cook a little extra and tell the old stories.

−2 Food, +2 Hope

Let it pass. There is no food to spare. You promise to celebrate on the other side.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 58/85

SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

Rumours of the Trail

A traveller says the way ahead is watched. Someone could go ahead alone to look.

Send a scout. The scout comes back hurt but knows the way.

someone takes 1 wound, turn up the next row

Go on blind. Trust the trail.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 59/85

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

UNTIL SUMMER 1975

DILEMMA

The March to Vientiane

Spring 1975. Thousands of Hmong are walking toward Vientiane, hoping to reach the Mekong together. Ahead, at the Hin Heup bridge, soldiers wait.

Walk with the crowd. There is safety in numbers, until the shooting starts.

+1 Hope, turn up the next row, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

Keep to the forest. Turn back into the hills, alone.

−1 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 60/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

A Crying Child

Soldiers are on the path below and a child will not stop crying. Many parents gave babies opium so their crying would not give the family away; some children died of it.

Quiet the child with opium. The crying stops. The child sleeps too long and wakes weak.

someone takes 1 wound

Hold the child and run. Carry the child and break for cover before the soldiers come.

−1 Hope, Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

THE TRAIL SEASON · 61/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

The Rooster Will Crow

The family must move tonight. A rooster crows at dawn and a dog barks at strangers. One boy had to leave his pet rooster behind for this reason.

Leave the animals behind. Let them go in the forest. The children cry quietly.

−1 Hope, lose your animals

Keep them close. Hold the beaks and muzzles and hope.

Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

THE TRAIL SEASON · 62/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

FROM FALL 1975

DILEMMA

The Chao Fa

Armed men with long hair stop you on the ridge: a Chao Fa band. They offer to let your family hide with them, but the army hunts them hardest.

Hide with them a while. They share what they know of the forest. Then the soldiers come.

−2 Food, +1 Hope, 1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

Keep to your own way. Thank them and walk on alone.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 63/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

Leaflets of Amnesty

Planes drop leaflets: those who come down from the mountains will be forgiven. Many who went were sent to re-education camps.

Stay hidden. Tear up the leaflets and keep going.

−1 Hope

Argue about it all night. The family is divided and no one sleeps.

+1 Food, −2 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 64/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 65/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 66/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 67/85

SEASON · FOG CHAO FA

FOG

Fog in the Valley

Gain a Fog card: discard it to avoid one fight (not the River Patrol).

A thick fog fills the valley for days.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 68/85

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · FOG CHAO FA

FOG

Fog in the Valley

Gain a Fog card: discard it to avoid one fight (not the River Patrol).

A thick fog fills the valley for days.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 69/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Smoke on the Far Ridge

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A village is burning across the valley. Is it yours?

THE TRAIL SEASON · 70/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Smoke on the Far Ridge

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A village is burning across the valley. Is it yours?

THE TRAIL SEASON · 71/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Dogs Bark All Night

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Somewhere below, the dogs will not settle.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 72/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Dogs Bark All Night

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Somewhere below, the dogs will not settle.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 73/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

A Spotter Plane

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A small plane circles twice and goes away.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 74/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

A Spotter Plane

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A small plane circles twice and goes away.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 75/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

The Grandmother's Dream

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

She dreamed of a river and a white horse. No one sleeps after that.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 76/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

The Grandmother's Dream

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

She dreamed of a river and a white horse. No one sleeps after that.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 77/85

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Footprints That Are Not Ours

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Someone else walked this path in the night.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 78/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

Footprints That Are Not Ours

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Someone else walked this path in the night.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 79/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

The Burning Season

This season every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better, and no one can Forage (Spring only).

Smoke from the swidden fires hangs over every valley. Nothing can be seen from far, and nothing grows in the ash.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 80/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

The Burning Season

This season every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better, and no one can Forage (Spring only).

Smoke from the swidden fires hangs over every valley. Nothing can be seen from far, and nothing grows in the ash.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 81/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

A Child Is Born

Hope +1. One adult goes **Hungry** this Winter. The baby is not a villager and cannot be lost.

A baby is born on the trail, in a shelter of leaves, and lives.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 82/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SPRING 1976

HISTORY

A Letter from America

Hope +1, and turn face up every place in the river row.

A letter, passed from hand to hand for months, from a relative already resettled. The river is the way.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 83/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM FALL 1975

HISTORY

The Writing of the Chao Fa

If the party holds the Book or the Pahawh Primer: **Hope +1** and one safe search here. Otherwise nothing.

A fighter shows you the script of Shong Lue Yang, the Mother of Writing, which the Chao Fa carry as their own.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 84/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

The Elder's Choice

The oldest of you, hungry and slow, asks to stay behind at this place so the young can move faster.

Stay together. No one is left. Every Danger draw is 1 worse until the next Winter.

no effect

Let him stay. He keeps a little rice and the fire. He is still in Laos. No Hope is lost, and his things pass to the party.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 85/85

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Lao Trader

A trader with a pole and two baskets stops to rest. He looks at what you carry.

Trade with him. Give up an item for rice and salt.

+4 Food, give up an item

Let him go. He might talk.

no effect

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 1/13

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Widow and Her Son

A Hmong widow and her small son have been hiding alone since the spring (Lee clan).

Take them with you. More mouths, but she knows the forest paths.

−3 Food, +1 Hope, turn up the next row

Give them what you can spare. A little rice and directions.

−1 Food, +1 Hope

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 2/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Deserter

A young soldier from the other side, without his rifle, wants to sell what he knows.

Pay him. He tells you where the patrols are.

give up an item, gain an escape card

Drive him off. He may go back to his unit.

Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 3/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Forest Monk

A Lao monk lives alone in a hut by the path. He has rice and a little medicine.

Ask for medicine. He tends your sick.

+1 Hope, a sick or wounded person recovers

Ask for rice. He shares his bowl.

+2 Food

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 4/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

Hmong Hunters

Two hunters from another clan are out for deer. They know these hills (Vang clan).

Hunt with them. Share the work and the meat.

+3 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

Ask the way. They draw the paths in the dirt.

turn up the next row

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 5/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Friendly Headman

A village headman smiles, offers rice and asks where you are going.

Tell him the truth. He may be a friend. He may not.

+2 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

Lie and leave at night. Hungry, but unseen.

−1 Hope

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 6/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Dying Fighter

An old resistance fighter, too sick to walk, says he hid things in this place.

Stay with him to the end. He tells you where to dig.

−1 Food, −1 Hope, 2 safe searches

Leave him your water. You go on.

−1 Hope

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 7/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

Lost Children

Three children whose parents were shot at the river are hiding in a hollow tree.

Take them. They slow you, but how could you not?

−3 Food, +2 Hope

Show them the way to a village. Lao farmers may take them in.

−2 Hope

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 8/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

An Opium Smuggler

A smuggler with a pack pony knows the back ways to the river, for silver.

Hire him. Pay, and he shows a hidden path.

give up an item, turn up the next row, gain an escape card

Keep away. Smugglers attract soldiers.

no effect

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 9/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Txiv Neeb on the Trail

A shaman travelling to a sick relative offers to call your souls home (Yang clan).

Hold a ceremony. Kill your last chicken and call the souls.

−1 Food, +2 Hope, a sick or wounded person recovers

Thank him. He blesses the children as he passes.

+1 Hope

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 10/13

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

Militia at the Spring

Village militia are filling their water at the spring you need.

Wait them out. Lie still until dark.
−1 Food

Rush them. Take their water and their gear.
1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

Men Around a Radio

Hmong men in a clearing listen to a radio from Thailand. Names of the people in the camps are read out.

Listen with them. You hear a cousin's name. He made it.
+2 Hope

Ask for news of the river. They tell you which crossings are watched.
+1 Hope, turn up the next row

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

A Lao Boatman

A lowland fisherman mending nets says he has taken Hmong families across before, and asks for nothing.

Accept his help. He will wait for you at the Fishing Hamlet.
+1 Hope

Keep away. You trust no one now.
no effect

STORY CLOTH · 1... CHAO FA

1961 TO 1975 · BEFORE

The Village

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families farmed the mountain slopes. From 1961 the men were recruited into a secret army; by 1969 it counted about 39,000, and planes dropped rice to the hill airstrips when the fields could no longer be farmed.

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

MAY 1975 · LEFT BEHIND

The Last Planes

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

On 14 May 1975 about 2,500 officers and their families were flown out of Long Tieng. Most soldiers and their families were left at their posts and had to walk.

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 ONWARD · THE NEW GOVERNMENT

The Soldiers Come

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Many officers and officials were sent to re-education "seminars" in remote camps, where many were starved or worked to death. At the Hin Heup bridge, soldiers fired on Hmong marching toward Vientiane.

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 TO 1976 · PHOU BIA

Into the Forest

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Others went into the forest. Former soldiers joined the Chao Fa, and Phou Bia, the highest mountain in Laos, became their stronghold. Whole villages hid with them.

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 TO 1980 · IN THE JUNGLE

Hiding

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families hid in the jungle with the fighters and moved on whenever the soldiers came close. One oral history speaks of more than 100,000 people in the jungles.

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1977 TO 1978 · THE OFFENSIVES

Fire from the Sky

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Vietnamese regiments were sent against Phou Bia, and thousands were killed or captured. Refugees told of "yellow rain" from aircraft; what it was is still disputed.

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 3

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 2

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 1

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 6

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 5

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 4

CHAO FA

STORY CLOTH · 7… CHAO FA

1975 TO 1980 · THE WAY OUT

The Walk South

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families walked for weeks toward the Mekong, carrying children and what they could. Up to a third of the Hmong of Laos left the country.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 7/9

STORY CLOTH · … CHAO FA

1975 TO 1992 · THE MEKONG

The Crossing

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

They crossed at night on bamboo floats, rafts or hired boats, and were shot at from the Lao bank. No one counted how many drowned. UNHCR counted 211,344 people from Laos reaching Thailand from 1975 to 1979.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 8/9

STORY CLOTH · … CHAO FA

1975 TO 1992 · BAN VINAI

The Camp

Read it aloud when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Ban Vinai held 42,858 people at its peak, 90 percent of them Hmong, and families waited years for a country to take them. In the Thai camps they began to stitch story cloths like this one, so the story would not be lost.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 9/9

FORTUNE · 1 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Dab phem

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

1

An ill spirit walks. Nothing goes right tonight.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 1/20

FORTUNE · 2 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Ntuj tsaus

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

2

A dark sky. The rain hides the soldiers, not you.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 2/20

FORTUNE · 3 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Huab cua phem

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

3

Bad weather. The path turns to mud under your feet.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 3/20

FORTUNE · 4 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Ib lub suab

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

4

A sound. A twig snaps, and someone heard it.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 4/20

FORTUNE · 5 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Hmoov phem

In a fight: an even clash.

5

Ill luck. The elders would have waited a day.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 5/20

FORTUNE · 6 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Hnub tsis tawm

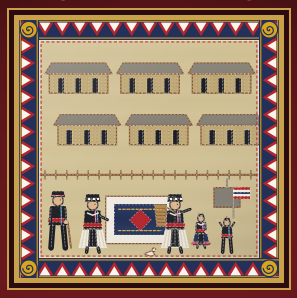
In a fight: an even clash.

6

The sun does not come out. A grey morning, a grey mood.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 6/20

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3



Square 9

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 8

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 7

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

FORTUNE · 7 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Tsis zoo

In a fight: an even clash.

7

Not good, not yet lost.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 7/20

FORTUNE · 8 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Nco tsev

In a fight: an even clash.

8

Homesick. You remember the village for a moment, and lose the trail.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 8/20

FORTUNE · 9 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Ua siab ntev

In a fight: an even clash.

9

Be patient. The hour is neither for you nor against you.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 9/20

FORTUNE · 10 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Kev khwv

In a fight: an even clash.

10

Hard work, as every day.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 10/20

FORTUNE · 11 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Mus ntsiag to

In a fight: an even clash.

11

Go quietly. The hills keep your secret.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 11/20

FORTUNE · 12 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Ib txoj kev

In a fight: an even clash.

12

One path among many. It will do.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 12/20

FORTUNE · 13 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Cov me nyuam luag

In a fight: an even clash.

13

The children laugh. Everyone walks a little lighter.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 13/20

FORTUNE · 14 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Noj mov

In a fight: an even clash.

14

A warm meal, and strength for the morning.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 14/20

FORTUNE · 15 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Pom kev

In a fight: an even clash.

15

You see the way ahead between the trees.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 15/20

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

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RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

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CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

FORTUNE · 16 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Siab tawv

In a fight: an even clash.

16

A brave heart. Courage runs through the party.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 16/20

FORTUNE · 17 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Ntuj pab

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

17

Heaven helps. The soldiers look the wrong way.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 17/20

FORTUNE · 18 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Hmoov zoo

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

18

Good fortune. The old sayings were right.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 18/20

FORTUNE · 19 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Qeej nrov

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

19

A qeej plays somewhere far off, and the spirits listen.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 19/20

FORTUNE · 20 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

Cob Fab

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

20

The Lord of the Sky rides. Nothing can touch you today.

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 20/20

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

Slack Water

Current check 6 better.

For a moment the great river is almost still.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 1/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

Slack Water

Current check 6 better.

For a moment the great river is almost still.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 2/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 3/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 4/21

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 5/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
A Drifting Log

Hold on to it: It carries you across, far downstream. You let go of everything you carry.

Let it go: The usual current check.

A log turns slowly past in the dark.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 6/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Searchlight

Dive and hold your breath: Current check 3 worse.

Lie still in the reeds: They may see you: Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

A patrol boat sweeps its light across the water.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 7/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Searchlight

Dive and hold your breath: Current check 3 worse.

Lie still in the reeds: They may see you: Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

A patrol boat sweeps its light across the water.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 8/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Whirlpool

Throw a rope or float: Spend a Rattan Rope, Bamboo Floats or an Inner Tube: you are pulled clear and cross.

Fight it alone: The river takes you: the drowning check.

The water turns in a circle and pulls down.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 9/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
Cramp

Someone across swims back: The strongest one already across goes back in: their current check 2 worse. Pass and both reach the bank; fail and both are swept away.

Float and pray: Swept away, but floating: the drowning check 2 better.

Legs lock in the cold water. A child cries out, or an old man stops swimming.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 10/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
A Sandbar

Current check 4 better.

Halfway across, sand under your feet. You can rest.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 11/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
Thai Fishermen

They pull you aboard and you cross. Under fire they turn back: the usual current check.

A small boat puts out from the Thai bank to meet you.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 12/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Raft Comes Apart

Current check 2 worse, and everyone still to cross on the raft must swim.

The bamboo lashings slip loose one by one.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 13/21

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

RIVER · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
Cold Water

Current check 1 worse; 4 worse for a child, elder, sick or wounded person.

The river is colder than anyone expected.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 14/21

RIVER · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
A Rain Squall

The usual current check, and no one else is shot going down to the water.

Rain comes down so hard the patrol cannot see the river.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 15/21

RIVER · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
A Line from the Thai Bank

Current check 8 better.

People on the far bank have seen you and throw a rope.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 16/21

RIVER · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
The Machine Gun

Swim under the water: Current check 4 worse.

Swim fast on the surface: Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

The patrol on the Lao bank opens fire into the water.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 17/21

RIVER · MONSOON · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
Flood Surge

Current check 5 worse.

A wall of brown water comes down the river.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 18/21

RIVER · MONSOON · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
Flood Surge

Current check 5 worse.

A wall of brown water comes down the river.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 19/21

RIVER · MONSOON · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
An Uprooted Tree

Hold on to the tree: It carries you across. You let go of everything you carry.

Swim clear of it: Current check 4 worse.

A whole tree comes down the flood, roots and all.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 20/21

RIVER · CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
Pushed Back

Current check 4 worse.

Thai soldiers on the far bank wave you off: the camps are full. You must land further down, in the dark.

THE TRAIL · RIVER · 21/21

TURNING POINT · CHAO FA

TURNING POINT
Hunted

For the rest of the game every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 worse, but every fight you win gives 1 more safe search.

The army has learned your family's names. Patrols carry a list.

THE TRAIL · TURNING POINT · 1/6

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

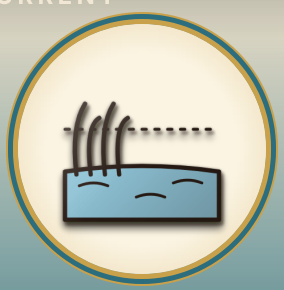
CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT



River

CHAO FA

TURNING POINT
Sickness Spreads

Each villager draws a Fortune card: on 8 or less they fall Sick.

Dysentery runs through the people hiding in the hills.

TURNING POINT
Word From Thailand

The passage needs 1 piece fewer. A Boatman waits at the Fishing Hamlet.

A message comes from a cousin in the camps: a fisherman at the hamlet will take you across.

TURNING POINT
The Long Rains

For the rest of the game the river is also in flood in Spring. Summer Forage finds 1 more Food everywhere.

The rains come early and stay late. The river rises and stays high.

TURNING POINT
Someone Is Following

The next time the party Travels, draw a Fortune card. On 10 or less he leads soldiers to you (a Hard fight). On 11 or more he is a Hmong man running too, and he joins you as a Guide.

A man has been walking behind you for two days, never closer, never gone.

TURNING POINT
The Mountain Falls

Every square still guarded is now On the Fallen. Soldiers everywhere use the "from 1977" row. Hope +1 for the families now walking with you.

Spring 1978. The army takes Phou Bia, and the families who hid there come down the paths behind you.

ENDING A · CARD 1 OF 3
Across the Mekong

The survivors climb the Thai bank. Like the families who really made this crossing, they are taken to a refugee camp such as Ban Vinai or Nong Khai, and wait there for years. Say aloud the names of those who did not reach the river.

Read on: card 2 of 3.

ENDING A · CARD 2 OF 3
Across the Mekong

Now lay out the nine squares of the story cloth, 1 to 9, and read them aloud in order: the whole journey, from the village to the camp, the way the story cloths stitched in the camps kept it.

Most of those who crossed were resettled in the United States, France, Australia, Canada and French Guiana. More than 330,000 people in the United States now identify as Hmong, the largest group around Minneapolis and St. Paul.

Read on: card 3 of 3.

ENDING A · CARD 3 OF 3
Across the Mekong

The ones who did not cross are part of this story too. Turn the page of this ending and read what happened to them.

For what really happened, from the Chao Fa's origins in 1959 to the families still hiding today, read the history in the companion book or the app.

Based on true stories.

ENDING B · CARD 1 OF 2
The ones who stayed

Those still alive turn back into the forest around Phou Bia. They join the people later called the Chao Fa: Hmong who stayed in the jungle after 1975, moving constantly, cut off from schools, clinics and work.

Lay out the squares of the story cloth you recovered and read them. The rest of the story stayed in the hills.

Read on: card 2 of 2.

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

The ones who stayed

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

ENDING B · CARD 2 OF 2

The ones who stayed

A Chao Fa leader said in 2018 that if nothing is done, his people "will not die from being killed in direct confrontation, but from starvation." The Lao government denies these accounts.

Many are still there, in hiding.

For what really happened, from the Chao Fa's origins in 1959 to the families still hiding today, read the history in the companion book or the app.

Based on true stories.

A TRUE STORY

Song Ly

market seller at Long Tieng

On 14 May 1975 she and her child boarded the last aircraft out of Long Tieng. Her husband, an air traffic controller, missed it. They found each other again within a month at the Nam Phong camp.

A TRUE STORY

May Lee Soung

nurse

She began nursing at Sam Thong hospital at 11 and watched soldiers whose wounds were beyond treatment die in front of her. In 1975 her family went to Vientiane and hired a boat across the Mekong.

A TRUE STORY

Neng "Nhia Cha" Xiong

lieutenant, recruited at 15

After 1975 he hid in the jungle, hunted by the soldiers. In 1979 he swam across the Mekong with his family, and lived at Ban Vinai until the camp closed.

A TRUE STORY

Youa K. Vue

survivor

In 1979 she made a hard choice: to leave her mother and siblings behind. After days of walking her group reached the Mekong and crossed safely. On the way she met and married Xai Chou Xiong, who promised to protect her. Her mother and siblings survived in Laos.

A TRUE STORY

Sao Ger Xiong

medic

His family hid in the jungle so he would not be imprisoned. In October 1979 he, his family and about 250 Hmong risked their lives to cross the Mekong together.

A TRUE STORY

Cha Ger Moua

boy soldier

Two of his brothers were killed, and in 1972 he joined the army as a boy to avenge them. From 1975 his family hid in the jungle. In May 1980 he crossed the Mekong with 361 other Hmong.

A TRUE STORY

Nhia Ge Vang

captain

After 1975 his community was moved into a village where they were ordered to learn the communist way of life. In 1979 he left for Thailand with about 1,000 Hmong.

A TRUE STORY

Xong Pao Hang

boy soldier, recruited at 13

His uniform had to be cut down to fit him. After 1975 his family hid. In 1978, as they fled toward Thailand, his mother and sister were shot dead by the troops pursuing them.

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

The ones who stayed

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Xai Chou Xiong

lieutenant

After 1975 his family hid in the jungle. Almost all of them were killed in one attack. He survived, and later reached the Thai camps.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 9/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Chong Neng Lor

platoon commander

Some of his soldiers were as young as 12. In 1975 he was sent to a re-education camp. He escaped from a work field into the forest and found his family in the jungle. They crossed in 1983, lived about 20 years in Thailand, and reached the United States in 2004.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 10/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Nhia Tou Pha

lieutenant

When the soldiers were rounded up, his family hid in the jungle. From 1975 to 1979 he fought with the Chao Fa resistance. In 1980 he fled to Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 11/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Tong Chang Lee

captain, wounded three times

After 1975 he resisted from the jungle. He escaped to Thailand in 1979 and lived in the camps for 25 years, at Ban Vinai and then Wat Tham Krabok. He reached the United States in 2005, with the last wave.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 12/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Tong Vang

veteran

He came back to Long Tieng and found all the planes gone. "If you lived, you live. If you died you died."

THE TRAIL VOICE · 13/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE … CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

Boua Vang Xiong

soldier

He kept fighting from 1973 to 1979. In May 1979 he fled to Thailand with his brother, leaving their parents behind.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 14/14

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

Council of Elders

The elders decide together. At every year end, +1 Hope, but 1 Food is cooked for the council.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 1/21

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

Travel by Night

Every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better, but each Forage finds 1 less Food.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 2/21

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

Proper Funerals

Deaths cost no Hope, but each burial uses 1 Food for the funeral meal.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 3/21

IF NO ONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

Voice

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WINTER COUNCIL

Law

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WINTER COUNCIL

Law

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WINTER COUNCIL

Law

CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

Everyone Nurses the Sick

Every Rest heals 1 extra wound or cures Sickness on any card, but each cure uses 1 Food for broth.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

LAW OF THE PARTY

Strict Rations

In Spring and Summer only half the party (rounded up) eats. -1 Hope at every year end while anyone is hungry.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

LAW OF THE PARTY

Travel Light

Each person keeps at most 3 items (discard the rest now). Every Danger draw is 2 better.

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

REFERENCE

Waiting, powers and escape · 1 of 3

When you cannot move (1 action each): **Lay an ambush** (once a place): next fight here you fire first. **Cover tracks** (once a season): noise here −2. **Trade** (village, hamlet, road, ferry): item for 3 Food, informer on a Fortune card of 1–3. **Share a meal** (once a season): 2 Food, Hope +1. **Seek help** (once a season): draw a Stranger.

Side A power: once a season (Old Road, Winter Clothes once a year). **Side B trait**: always on.

Armor: stops that much damage to its

REFERENCE

Waiting, powers and escape · 2 of 3

Escape card: when soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: no fight.

Omens: on the Omen row of the board; each new one, a Fortune card at or under the row's number = the Turning Point (draw 1 of 6, once a game).

Clan: a Stranger of a clan in the party gives the better answer for nothing.

Hidden field (Spring, at the fields, the stream or the Vientiane plain, 1 Food): planted; +4 Food in Fall if you are still there and no fight has happened here.

REFERENCE

Waiting, powers and escape · 3 of 3

Animals: a Horse or Water Buffalo carries one more pack slot and may be slaughtered for 4 Food and −1 Hope; neither goes into the caves or across the river. **Disguise**: two disguise pieces in the party and a Guarded or Price key is not stepped up.

REFERENCE

A season on the trail · 1 of 3

Season card: draw and resolve; answer dilemmas together.

2 actions each (1 if Sick; −1 at Hope 0): Search · Scout · Forage · Rest or nurse · Build camp · Side A power · Play a card · Give an item.

Travel (first thing in the season, instead of any actions): move the party to a known place next to it, draw a Fortune card against its Danger, gather forage, and the season ends.

REFERENCE

A season on the trail · 2 of 3

Hard work eats: Search, Scout, Build and Travel cost 1 Food (none left: the worker takes a wound). **Winter**: eat 1 Food each; each short is a wound. Forage: +1 wherever the tile shows any.

Carry: 2 hands (rifles, bows and spears take both), 1 body, 1 head, 3 pack. Animals, boats and raft wood are shared. Too much? Hand it on or leave it.

Unnursed sick: die on a Fortune card of 1–5.

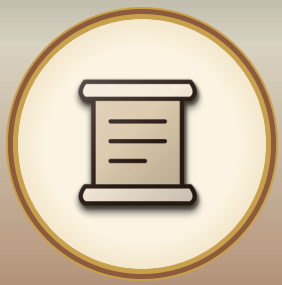
REFERENCE

A season on the trail · 3 of 3

Winter: the Toll, then draw 2 laws; the council may adopt one.

Fallen players: once a season, give a living villager 1 more action.

WINTER COUNCIL



Law

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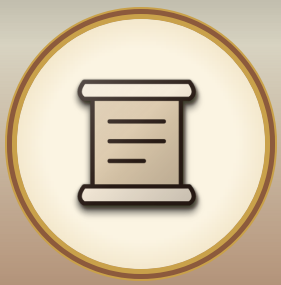
WINTER COUNCIL



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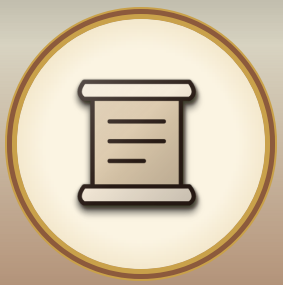

Law

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KEEP FACE UP

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REFERENCE

Fights and noise · 1 of 3

1 · The soldiers: one number from the Patrol table (the row is the fight, the column your living villagers, the block the year) is their ATK, DEF and HP. Nothing is added. Add up the party's ATK, DEF and HP.

2 · Clash, up to 3 times: draw 1 Fortune card (1–4: soldiers +2 ATK; 17–20: party +2 ATK). You deal your ATK minus their number; they deal their number minus your DEF, **always at least 1**. You choose who is hit; Armor stops it first.

3 · The cost: their damage reaches their number = you win and search here in

REFERENCE · FIGHTS CHAO FA

REFERENCE

Fights and noise · 2 of 3

Prisoner: a villager who falls in a fight (not the river) draws a Fortune card: 1–10 killed, 11–20 taken prisoner (Ending 4). Either way, everything they carried is lost.

Break away (after clash 1 or 2): discard one item per living villager instead of taking their hit; the fight ends, nothing gained.

Shakedown (Easy fights only): hand over 2 Food or one money item and walk on. No fight.

Loud weapons: a fight with any loud weapon puts an Alarm token on the

REFERENCE · FIGHTS CHAO FA

REFERENCE

Fights and noise · 3 of 3

Night (Travel by Night, after moving): the soldiers' number and your ATK are both 1 lower. **A carried child**: the carrier has one hand and ATK −1; the child cannot be hit.

Noise: searching a place again, a Fortune card at or under its earlier searches = soldiers (no spoils).

REFERENCE

The Toll and the river · 1 of 3

Toll: each person draws a Fortune card, falls Sick on 5 or less. +1 child, elder, wounded or sick; +1 per Food short (max 3); +cold (1975 0, 76–77 +1, 78–79 +2); Hope 0 +2, 1–2 +1, 5–6 −1; healer −1; finished camp −1; warm items up to −2. Sick and taken again: dies.

Guard tokens: when a key encounter is drawn and left, its guard token goes on the tile so the table sees where the keys are.

REFERENCE · WINT… CHAO FA

REFERENCE

The Toll and the river · 2 of 3

Keys: every key is guarded, one step harder than its place (hard → deadly); a win recovers the next square of the story cloth. **River**: need all 9 squares (sewn at the start: a party of 6 has squares 1–2, 5 has 1–3, 4 has 1–4, 3 has 1–5; Short Trail 3 more), on any river place. A fallen carrier's squares go into the top 3 of that place's search deck. 1 Hope lets one person draw again at the current or when drowning. River Patrol: its own row of the Patrol table, no escape cards; up to 3 clashes; still standing = cross under fire (no

REFERENCE · WINT… CHAO FA

REFERENCE

The Toll and the river · 3 of 3

Low water (Spring, not monsoon): the current is 2 better. **The tributary** (lowlands to river, Summer or Fall): a Fortune card, on 1–2 the heaviest load loses an item.

Boat: four seats a trip; a second trip meets the River Patrol again. **Washed up**: swept away and drawing 18 or more, you reach the Thai bank alone with nothing.

REFERENCE · 1 OF 3

Symbol key

Search: draw the top card of this place

Scout: turn a hidden place face up

Travel: the party moves; the season ends

Rest / Nurse: heal 1, or break a fever

Camp: a finished camp heals 2 and eases the Toll

Food: the store; eaten in Winter

Hope: 0 to 6; sets the Toll and the actions

Wound: −1 HP; at 0 the villager falls

Sick: one action; cured by nursing

REFERENCE · SYMB… CHAO FA

REFERENCE · 2 OF 3

Symbol key

Danger III / IIII: Hard and Deadly fights

River Patrol ~: the fight at the bank

Ambush: the soldiers fire first

Escape: discard: no fight

Fortune 1–4: soldiers +2 this clash

Fortune 17–20: party +2 this clash

Alarm: next fight here this season one row harder

Guard: a key encounter waits here

Key: a square of the story cloth

Omen: on the Omen row; brings the Turning Point

REFERENCE · SYMB… CHAO FA

REFERENCE · 3 OF 3

Symbol key

Quiet weapon: no alarm; a hunter fires first

Cannot swim: drowns 2 worse without a float

Money: pays a Boatman, a Price, a Trade, a shakedown

Animal: one more pack slot; 3 Food if slaughtered

Disguise: two pieces: no step up at a key

Cache: items left on a tile

Planted field: harvest +2 Food when you return

KEEP FACE UP

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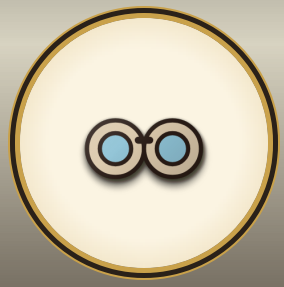

Reference

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SETUP · THE PHOU … CHAO FA

SETUP CARD · A HISTORICAL TRAIL

The Phou Bia Trail

Lay face down, left to right. **Hills**: Swidden Fields, Plain of Jars, Long Tieng Airstrip. **Jungle**: Phou Bia Slopes, Phou Khao Khouay Jungle, Limestone Caves. **Lowlands**: Lao Farm Village, Nam Xan Valley, Vientiane Plain. **River**: Mekong Reeds, Fishing Hamlet, Tha Deua Ferry.

Far bank: Bueng Kan, then the camp at Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 1/3

SETUP · THE VIENTI… CHAO FA

SETUP CARD · A HISTORICAL TRAIL

The Vientiane Road

Lay face down, left to right. **Hills**: Swidden Fields, Pine Ridge, Long Tieng Airstrip. **Jungle**: Bamboo Forest, Phou Khao Khouay Jungle, Limestone Caves. **Lowlands**: Lao Farm Village, Hin Heup Bridge, Vientiane Plain. **River**: Mekong Reeds, Fishing Hamlet, Tha Deua Ferry.

Far bank: Nong Khai, then the camp at Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 2/3

SCENARIO · THE LA… CHAO FA

SCENARIO · AFTER A GAME

The Late Crossing, 1979

Spring 1979 (season 17), a lowlands place, the squares you held (at least six). Patrol table face 2 only; Pushed Back in the River deck. Food 2 each, Hope 2. The camps close after season 24.

The villagers alive in Laos at the last Winter try again.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 3/3

THE LATE CROSSING

Scenario

CHAO FA

THE VIENTIANE ROAD

Setup card

CHAO FA

THE PHOU BIA TRAIL

Setup card

CHAO FA